Seated brace with normal breathing

Trunk stability / 3 relaxed breaths per hold; 3 holds



SETUP / balanced sitting HOLD / gentle brace and breathing

MAIN: Abdominal wall: develops gentle trunk stiffness while breathing.

SECONDARY: Deep spinal stabilizers cooperate with the abdominal wall; breathing muscles continue their normal work.

BASE / SUPPORT: Chair contact and planted feet steady the pelvis. Hip and leg muscles provide light postural support.

01 / Check the setup

Use a stable chair. No band is required; this is a low-effort control drill.

02 / Set the base and brace

Sit comfortably tall with ribs over pelvis and both feet on the floor. Keep shoulders relaxed and avoid arching the back.

03 / Move with control

Gently firm the midsection as if preparing for a light nudge. Take slow normal breaths without bearing down.

04 / Limit the range and return

Hold only while breathing and posture stay easy. Release fully between attempts; no trunk movement is needed.

WATCH FOR: Do not suck the stomach in forcefully, brace maximally or hold the breath. EASIER: Use a lighter contraction for fewer breaths with back support if comfortable.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: AAOS - Spine Conditioning Program. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html